

VEHICLE SAFETY TECHNOLOGY

Innovation and advancement in the vehicle industry has led to the development of safety systems that help reduce the negative outcomes of human error and unsafe behavior. Vehicle Safety Technology (VST) and Advanced Driver Assistance Systems (ADAS) reduce the impact of crashes by trying to prevent them from happening. They can give you advanced or additional warnings that improve your response time. They are meant to assist your already-healthy driving habits, not replace them. You are still fully responsible for the operation of your vehicle.

Even with VST and ADAS, you still need to use your hazard awareness skills and knowledge of the rules of the road because these systems do have limitations. For example, these systems can alert you if there is a vehicle in your blind spot; however, they can't detect if there is a vehicle two lanes over that is also preparing to merge. Also, your vehicle's detection technologies might not recognize the presence of people walking, rolling, or riding near your vehicle. It is your responsibility to yield according to state law. Additionally, sensors can get dirty or road markings can fade, making it difficult for the technology to function properly.

It's important you are familiar with the features and technologies of any vehicle you drive. Leave them on unless weather conditions are so severe that the notifications become a distraction. Ensure you can use these features effectively. To learn more about the safety technologies your vehicle has, read your vehicle manual, ask a car dealership, or visit mycardoeswhat.org.